Topic 11 — Swadeshi (स्वदेशी) & Revolutionary (क्रांतिकारी) Movement

Covers syllabus (click to expand)

Partition of Bengal | Swadeshi Movement | Delhi Durbar | Revolutionary Organisations | Revolutionary Centres | Revolutionary Activities | Revolutionary Events | Anushilan (अनुशीलन) Samiti (समिति) | Jugantar (युगांतर) | HSRA | Ghadar (ग़दर) Party | Kakori Conspiracy | Chittagong Armoury Raid | Hindustan Republican Association | Barrah Dacoity | Bagha Jatin | India House (इंडिया हाउस) | Kamagata Maru | Provisional Government Kabul

Sources baked in: Spectrum, Bipan Chandra, NCERT Themes III, Ghatnachakra Purvalokan (Revolutionary Movements / Outside India), UPPCS Prelims 2018–2025 **Weight:** ★★★ — 1905/1911, org↔event, Kakori UP, Hardinge bomb, revolutionary chronology **Last verified:** September 2026 gap audit — Abhinav/India House + HRA + Chapekar + Komagata Maru CCR filled; Swadeshi header glue fixed; UKPCS bank harvested from Extra; Extra Drill present (no invented mega banks) **Current Affairs:** N/A (historical)

11.1 Overview

- **1905** opens two streams.
- One is open **Swadeshi–Boycott** politics.
- The other is underground **revolutionary** groups.
- Extremists (Lal–Bal–Pal, Aurobindo) led the public movement.
- Secret societies recruited the youth the police then drove underground.
- **Surat Split 1907** broke Congress.
- Open Swadeshi faded after **1908**. Bombs and conspiracies did not.
- Bengal was a centre for Anushilan, Jugantar and Chittagong.
- Maharashtra was a centre for Abhinav Bharat and Nasik.
- Punjab was a centre for Ghadar returnees, HSRA and Lahore.
- UP was a centre for Kakori, Shahjahanpur and Allahabad.
- London had India House. North America had Ghadar. Berlin had the **1915** committee.

Logic: Extremist Congress politics ≠ revolutionary secret societies. Tilak (तिलक) is Extremist; Kakori is revolutionary.

11.2 Partition of Bengal (1905)

Viceroy: Lord Curzon **Announced:** July 1905 **Effective: 16 October 1905** | **Annulled: 1911** (Delhi Durbar)

Causes

- Curzon's official reason was that Bengal, with roughly 78 million people, was too large for one administration to govern well.
- Nationalists read it as **divide and rule**: a Muslim-majority east split from a Hindu-majority west would weaken the united Bengali politics that Calcutta had built.
- Calcutta was also the base of India's most organised anti-Raj press and public opinion, which the split aimed to fragment.

Course

- Partition became effective on **16 October 1905**. A new province, **East Bengal and Assam**, was created with capital at **Dacca (Dhaka)**; western Bengal stayed linked with Bihar and Orissa under Calcutta.
- **16 October 1905** was observed as a day of mourning. People tied **Rakhi** across communities as a sign of unity, and Tagore's ***Amar Sonar Bangla*** became the protest anthem.
- Anti-Partition protest fused at once with **Swadeshi and boycott** — bonfires of foreign cloth, volunteer samitis and the Boycott Resolution all grew out of this anger (full card in 11.3).
- Both statements are true — Curzon rearranged provincial boundaries, **and** East Bengal & Assam was constituted.
- Partition of Bengal is Curzon's best-known administrative act.

Results

- Partition failed to kill Bengali political unity. It instead produced the largest mass protest India had yet seen, feeding both open Swadeshi politics and the underground revolutionary stream (11.5 onward).
- Facing sustained agitation, the British **annulled the Partition in 1911** at the Delhi Durbar. The same package **moved the imperial capital from Calcutta to Delhi**.
- Annulment did not erase the communal politics that Partition had stirred; the Muslim League's separate political identity had already begun to harden by 1906.
- **Lucknow Pact is 1916**, not 1911 — do not merge it with the annulment package.

> **Logic:** Partition **1905** / annulment **1911**. New province = **East Bengal and Assam**.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2019, Q95

> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor (UPPCS 2019 Q95):** Lord Curzon rearranged Bengal provincial boundaries in 1905, creating the new province of **East Bengal and Assam** (HQ at Dacca) under Lt. Governor Sir Andrew Fraser.

Launch fact: 7 August 1905 — Boycott Resolution, Calcutta Town Hall **Peak:** 1905–08 **Congress stamp:** Calcutta session (पंगु सत्र) **1906** (Dadabhai) — goal declared as **Swaraj**

Causes

- The Partition of Bengal (11.2) was the immediate trigger, but Swadeshi also drew on decades of economic nationalism — Dadabhai Naoroji (नौरोजी)'s drain-of-wealth argument and long resentment at the collapse of Indian handicrafts under cheap British imports.
- Extremist leaders argued that petitions and prayers to a colonial government had achieved little, and that self-reliant, assertive action was the only real answer.

Course

- Swadeshi means **use Indian goods and institutions**. Boycott means **reject British goods** and, in the Extremist programme, schools, courts, titles and jobs.
- Methods included bonfires of Manchester cloth.
- Indians started mills, soap and matches. **P.C. Ray's Bengal Chemical** is the enterprise tag.
- Volunteer **samitis** organised the districts.
- The press included *Bande Mataram*, *Yugantar* and *Kesari*.
- The **National Council of Education** was set up in **August 1906**. **Bengal National College** had **Aurobindo** as principal. BHU is a later, separate university stream.
- **Ashwini Kumar Dutt's Swadesh Bandhab Samiti (Barisal)** is the classic district volunteer body.
- **V.O. Chidambaram Pillai** founded the **Swadeshi Steam Navigation Company (कंपनी)** at Tuticorin against British shipping.
- Bengal was the epicentre. Maharashtra followed under Tilak, Punjab under Lajpat Rai (राई), and Madras/Tuticorin under VOC Pillai.
- Moderates wanted boycott of **goods** and pressure on British public opinion. Extremists wanted **passive resistance** (निष्क्रिय प्रतिरोध) and Swaraj language. That fight split Congress at **Surat 1907**.

Results

- Government repression crushed the **open** movement after **1908**; much of its youth moved into the underground **Anushilan / Jugantar** stream instead of staying with Congress platforms.
- The sustained pressure of Swadeshi and boycott is part of why the **Partition of Bengal was annulled in 1911** — the same political result taught fully under 11.2.
- The Moderate–Extremist split hardened into the **Surat Split of 1907**, weakening Congress unity for the next several years.

Bengal Swadeshi leaders map

Leader	Role in Swadeshi	tag
Surendranath Banerjee (बनर्जी)	Moderate Bengal voice who still backed Swadeshi and boycott in 1905–06	*A Nation in Making (ए नेशन इन मेकिंग)*; later joined Indian Association politics
Bipin Chandra Pal (बिपिन चंद्र पाल)	Extremist orator of the **Lal–Bal–Pal** trio; preached passive resistance and full boycott	Edited *New India*; pushed Swaraj as a right
Rabindranath Tagore	Wrote ***Amar Sonar Bangla*** as the anti-Partition anthem; organised **Rakhi Bandhan** on 16 October 1905	Later grew uneasy with Extremist violence

Leader	Role in Swadeshi	tag
Aurobindo Ghosh	Principal of **Bengal National College**; edited ***Bande Mataram***; moved from open politics into the Jugantar underground before Pondicherry (पांडिचेरी)	Acquitted in the Alipore Case (1908–09)

- Banerjee kept faith in constitutional protest even as the movement radicalised around him.
- Pal and Tilak supplied the all-India Extremist voice; Lajpat Rai supplied Punjab.
- Tagore's song (सोंग) and the Rakhi ceremony fused **cultural** protest with the **political** boycott.
- Aurobindo is the bridge figure: he ran the open National College **and** moved through the secret Jugantar circle before he left politics for good.

> **Logic:** Boycott Resolution = **7 Aug 1905**. NCE = **1906**. Swaraj as Congress goal = **Calcutta 1906**. Match leader ↔ role, not leader ↔ organisation names alone.

11.4 Delhi Durbar — 1877 and 1911

1877 Durbar: Viceroy **Lytton**; proclaimed **Queen Victoria as Empress of India** at Delhi. It was an assertion of imperial pageantry, not a partition-related event.

1911 Durbar: Viceroy **Hardinge**; king-emperor **George V** attended in person, the only reigning British sovereign to visit India as king-emperor. This is the **high-yield** Durbar for Prelims.

- Do not merge the two Durbars. **1877** = title (Empress of India). **1911** = annulment of Partition **and** the capital shift.
- The Durbar of **1911** had two key facts.
- **Partition of Bengal was annulled**.
- The **capital shifted from Calcutta to Delhi**.
- The **1911** Delhi Durbar package linked partition annulment and capital shift to Delhi — not the Lucknow Pact (**1916**).
- On **12 December 1911** George V announced annulment and the capital move; the transfer was completed in **1912** under **Hardinge II**.
- Annulment reunited Bengal roughly. **Bihar and Orissa** became a separate province (**from 1 April 1912**). Assam was restored toward its earlier separate status.
- Do not treat 1911 as “nothing changed,” and do not put the **Lucknow Pact** (लखनऊ पैक्ट) in the Durbar year.
- The new capital project at Delhi is Hardinge’s years (later New Delhi inauguration is 1931 — not this card’s fact).

> **Logic:** 1911 = **annulment + capital to Delhi**. Not Lucknow Pact. Not Partition year (that is 1905).

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2025, Q6

> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor (UPPCS 2025 Q6):** At the **Delhi Durbar of December 1911**, King George V announced the **revocation of Bengal partition** and the **transfer of British India's capital from Calcutta to Delhi** (effective 1912). The Lucknow Pact occurred later in 1916.

11.5 Revolutionary Organisations, Centres and Activities

Centre	Groups / events
Bengal	Anushilan, Jugantar, Alipore, Chittagong, Dhaka Anushilan (Pulin Behari Das)
Maharashtra	Chapekar (1897); Abhinav Bharat; Nasik / Jackson (1909)
Punjab / Lahore	Ghadar returnees; Naujawan Bharat Sabha; HSRA; Saunders; Lahore Conspiracy
UP	Mainpuri; Shahjahanpur; **Kakori**; Gorakhpur (Bismil hanged); Allahabad / Alfred Park (Azad)
Madras	Vanchinathan kills Collector Ashe (1911), Tinnevelly
London	India House — Shyamji Krishna Varma; Madan Lal Dhingra (Curzon Wyllie, 1909)
N. America	Ghadar Party, San Francisco, 1913
Berlin	Indian Independence Committee, 1915

- Revolutionary activity means **secret armed groups**, not Congress Extremists.
- The first generation belongs to **1907–15**. It includes Bengal bombs, India House and the Ghadar wartime rising.
- The second generation belongs to **1924–31**.
- That line is HRA, then Kakori, then HSRA, then Saunders, the Assembly bomb, Lahore and Chittagong.
- Azad was killed in **1931**.

> **Logic:** Match **org** ↔ **event**, not long biographies. UP's scoring event is **Kakori**.

11.6 Anushilan Samiti

Founded: 1902, Calcutta (**Pramathanath Mitra** / Barrister P. Mitra) **Dhaka branch: Pulin Behari Das** (**1906**)

- A secret society for physical culture, discipline and political violence against the Raj.
- Aurobindo and Barindra Ghosh moved in this Bengal underground. The Dhaka Anushilan was especially organised.
- The **Barrah (Barra) Dacoity** of **1908** in East Bengal was planned by **Pulin Behari Das**'s Dhaka Anushilan circle as an early major armed venture for funds and arms.

- **Sachindra Nath Sanyal** opened an Anushilan branch at **Patna in 1913**.
- Do not merge Anushilan with the later HSRA of Punjab–UP.

Hardinge bomb / Delhi Conspiracy (1912) — Cause → Course → Result

Causes

- After open Swadeshi was crushed, Anushilan cells sought a spectacular strike on the highest symbol of the Raj in India — the Viceroy — to prove that underground action still lived.
- The **1911** capital shift to Delhi gave them a public procession target in Chandni Chowk.

Course

- On **23 December 1912** a bomb was thrown at Viceroy **Hardinge** in the Chandni Chowk procession (Delhi Conspiracy).
- **Rash Behari Bose** planned it; **Basanta Kumar Biswas** threw it.
- Hardinge was wounded; the procession was broken; a wide conspiracy hunt followed across North India.

Results

- The Hardinge bomb (**1912**, Delhi Conspiracy) is linked to **Anushilan Samiti**, not Jugantar and not a labour body.
- Rash Behari Bose escaped into exile and later became the Japan–INA (आज़ाद हिंद फौज) bridge figure; several associates were hanged or transported.
- For Prelims, keep Hardinge **1912** = **Anushilan**; Muzaffarpur **1908** = **Jugantar**.

> **Logic:** Hardinge bomb **1912** = **Anushilan**. Jugantar is the other Bengal circle.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2023, Q42

> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor (UPPCS 2023 Q42):** In the **Delhi Conspiracy (23 Dec 1912)**, **Rash Behari Bose** and the **Anushilan Samiti** planned the bomb thrown by Basanta Kumar Biswas at Viceroy Lord Hardinge during the state entry into Delhi.

11.7 Jugantar / Yugantar

- **Jugantar (Yugantar)** is the Bengal action circle around **Barindra Kumar Ghosh**. It is also the weekly ***Yugantar*** newspaper and the **Manicktolla garden** bomb factory (फैक्टरी) in Calcutta.

Muzaffarpur bomb and Alipore Case — Cause

- Jugantar wanted to answer the repression of the Swadeshi movement with direct armed action, and **Kingsford**, an unpopular judge who had given harsh sentences to Swadeshi protesters, became their chosen target.

Course

- On **30 April 1908** at **Muzaffarpur**, **Khudiram Bose** and **Prafulla Chaki** threw a bomb at what they believed was Kingsford's carriage; two British women were killed instead.
- Chaki shot himself rather than be captured; Khudiram was tried and hanged.
- The attack led police to the Manicktolla garden, and the **Alipore Conspiracy Case (1908–09)** put Aurobindo, Barindra and others on trial for the wider bomb conspiracy.

Results

- Aurobindo was acquitted, defended by **C.R. Das**; he then left politics altogether for Pondicherry yoga (योग).
- Barindra Ghosh and other convicted members were transported to the Andamans, breaking up the Jugantar network for some years.
- Inside Alipore Jail, **Kanailal Dutt** and **Satyendranath Bose** shot the approver **Narendra Gosain**; both were hanged.
- **Jatindranath Mukherjee (Bagha Jatin)** later reorganised the **Yugantar** wartime line and died in **1915** fighting.
- Surviving Jugantar men later fed into wartime plots and, through personal links, into the 1930 Chittagong generation. For Prelims, keep Jugantar tied to **Muzaffarpur + Alipore + Yugantar paper**.

> **Logic:** Khudiram–Chaki = **Muzaffarpur 1908**. Hardinge 1912 = **Anushilan**, not Jugantar, in the 2023 key.

11.8 Abhinav Bharat and India House

Abhinav Bharat — Cause → Course → Result

Founded line: V.D. Savarkar founded **Mitra Mela (1899)** and converted it into the secret **Abhinav Bharat Society (1904)** in Maharashtra (branches also in Madhya Pradesh and Karnataka); a London branch worked from **India House (1906)**.

Causes

- Savarkar's circle wanted a Mazzini-style secret society for armed national rising, not only Congress Extremism.
- Maharashtra's Chapekar memory (**1897**) and Tilak's assertive politics gave the young group a local climate of revolt.

Course

- Abhinav Bharat trained cadres for political violence and ran pamphlets and arms talk across Maharashtra and abroad.
- In **1909** at Nasik, **Anant Kanhere** killed Collector **Jackson**; Abhinav Bharat men were tried in the Nasik Conspiracy.
- Savarkar wrote ***The Indian War of Independence (इंडियन वॉर ऑफ इंडिपेंडेंस)*** **(**1909**) and on** Mazzini** to inspire nationalists. Arrested in London for the Nasik Conspiracy, he jumped from a ship

trying to escape, was re-arrested, and sent to the Andamans.

Results

- The Nasik trials and Savarkar's transportation broke the open Abhinav Bharat network inside India.
- The idea of a secret armed society survived in later North Indian revolutionary work, but Prelims keys lock Abhinav Bharat to **Savarkar + Maharashtra**, not Bengal or Punjab.

India House (London) — Cause → Course → Result

Founder: Shyamji Krishna Varma | Place: London | **Paper: *The Indian Sociologist* | Linked body:** Indian Home Rule (होम रूल) Society; scholarships for Indian students

Causes

- Indian students in London needed a centre that preached self-rule and published anti-colonial argument beyond Moderate petition politics.
- Shyamji used scholarships and a hostel to gather radical students away from official India Office influence.

Course

- India House became the London hub for Savarkar's circle, Madan Lal Dhingra and other émigrés.
- In **1909**, **Madan Lal Dhingra** killed **Curzon Wyllie** at the Imperial Institute.
- Police pressure then crushed India House as an open centre.

Results

- The killing and crackdown scattered the London network; survivors fed into Paris (Cama) and later wartime plots.
- Hold the pair: **Abhinav Bharat = Savarkar**; **India House = Shyamji Krishna Varma**. **Dhingra ≠ Bhagat Singh**.

> **Logic:** Abhinav Bharat = **Savarkar**. India House = **Shyamji Krishna Varma**. Dhingra ≠ Bhagat Singh.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2018, Q22

> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor (UPPCS 2018 Q22): Vinayak Damodar (V.D.) Savarkar** started *Mitra Mela* in 1899 at Nasik, which was reconstituted as the secret society **Abhinav Bharat Society** in 1904.

11.9 Madam Bhikaji Cama and the Stuttgart Flag (1907)

Who:Bhikaji Rustom Cama, Parsi revolutionary from Bombay, based in Paris/London after 1902
Event:22 August 1907, International Socialist Congress, **Stuttgart**, Germany

- Madam Cama worked with the London **India House** circle around Shyamji Krishna Varma and with **S.R. Rana** and **Munchershah Godrej** in Paris.

- At Stuttgart she unfurled what is remembered as an **early version of the Indian national flag**: horizontal green–yellow–red bands, with **eight lotuses** for the eight then-provinces, ***Vande Mataram*** in the centre band, and a sun and crescent at the ends.
- She appealed to the international socialist delegates for support of India's freedom, calling the flag "the flag of Indian independence."
- She published the paper ***Bande Mataram*** from Paris and later ***Madan's Talwar*** in memory of Madan Lal Dhingra.
- The French government, under British pressure, kept her under watch; she could not return to India until near her death in **1936**.
- She is remembered as the **Mother of the Indian Revolution**.
- She also worked as a private secretary to **Dadabhai Naoroji** for a time.
- Do not confuse her Stuttgart flag (1907) with the **Berlin Committee** (1915), a separate, later wartime plot in Europe.

> **Logic:** Cama = **1907 Stuttgart flag**, Paris base. Berlin Committee = **1915** wartime plot, different generation of émigré politics.

11.10 Ghadar Party

Year: 1913 | **Place: San Francisco** (Pacific Coast; earlier Hindi Association, Portland/Astoria) **Leaders: Sohan Singh Bhakna** (president), **Lala Hardayal Paper: *Ghadar***

Causes

- Indian migrant labourers on the Pacific coast faced racial discrimination and exclusion laws in Canada and the US, convincing them that Indians would never get fair treatment while British rule continued at home.
- Revolutionary exiles such as **Lala Hardayal** carried the India House message of armed struggle into the North American diaspora.

Course

- Diaspora Sikhs, Hindus and Muslims on the Pacific coast formed a party in **1913** to **overthrow British rule by armed revolt**, especially once a war gave them the opportunity.
- When the First World War broke out, Ghadarites returned to Punjab in **1914–15** hoping to spark a mutiny among Indian troops.

Results

- The planned rising failed and collapsed in **February 1915**. Many Ghadarites were hanged or jailed in the **Lahore Conspiracy** trials that followed.
- Surviving members and sympathisers later fed into the wartime **Berlin Committee** network — a related but separate story (11.11). Ghadar (**1913**) came **before** the Berlin Committee (**1915**).

> **Logic:** Ghadar = **1913 San Francisco**. Berlin Committee = **1915**. Order in 2022: Ghadar → Berlin → Assembly 1929 → Chittagong 1930 (चटगाँव).

Komagata Maru (1914) — Cause → Course → Result

Ship: Japanese steamer ***Komagata Maru*** | **Charterer: Gurdit Singh** | **Destination aimed:** Vancouver, Canada

Causes

- Canadian immigration rules blocked most Indian migrants while still favouring white settlers — a racial empire fact Ghadar wanted to expose.
- Gurdit Singh hired the ship to carry Punjabi passengers who claimed the right to enter as British subjects.

Course

- Canada refused most passengers landing rights; after weeks in harbour the ship was forced to turn back.
- On return near **Budge Budge** (Calcutta), a confrontation with British police led to firing and deaths among passengers.

Results

- Ghadar used Komagata Maru as proof that racial exclusion was built into British imperial law.
- The episode sits in the overseas chain **between** Ghadar founding (**1913**) and the wartime rising attempts (**1914–15**). Do not treat it as a separate party from Ghadar.

> **Logic:** Komagata Maru = **1914 + Gurdit Singh + Canada refusal + Budge Budge**. It is a **Ghadar-era** episode, not Berlin Committee.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2022, Q38

> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor (UPPCS 2022 Q38):** Revolutionary Chronology: **Ghadar Party** (1913, San Francisco) → **Berlin Committee / Indian Independence Committee** (1915, Germany) → **Central Assembly Bomb Case** (8 April 1929) → **Chittagong Armoury Raid** (18 April 1930).

11.11 Berlin Committee (Indian Independence Committee, 1915)

Founded:1915, Berlin **Key figures:Virendranath Chattopadhyay**, **Bhupendranath Dutta**, with German Foreign Office wartime support **Aim:** use Germany's war against Britain to arm and fund an Indian rising

- The First World War gave émigré revolutionaries in Europe a state sponsor. Germany wanted to destabilise British India.

- The committee tried to smuggle arms to India, link with Ghadar returnees in Punjab, and stir mutiny among Indian troops and prisoners of war.
- **Har Dayal**, already active with Ghadar in America, also moved through this German-backed network for a time.
- An attempted German arms shipment to India (the **Annie Larsen/Maverick affair**, on the American coast) was intercepted by the Americans in 1915–17.
- The plan failed to trigger a mass rising, but it kept revolutionary diplomacy alive through the war years.
- Keep Berlin **1915** distinct from Ghadar **1913** (America) and from Cama's Stuttgart flag **1907** (pre-war).

> **Logic:** Berlin Committee **1915** = wartime Europe plot. Chronology: Ghadar (1913) → Berlin (1915) → Assembly bomb (1929) → Chittagong (1930).

11.12 Hindustan Republican Association (HRA)

Year: 1924 | Place of organisation: Kanpur (कानपुर) **Founders / early leaders: Sachindra Nath Sanyal, Jogesh Chandra Chatterjee, Ram Prasad Bismil**

Causes

- After wartime crackdowns, North Indian revolutionaries wanted a fresh all-India armed organisation aimed at a **republic**, not only local bombs.
- Sanyal's ***The Revolutionary*** (Yellow Paper) and ***Bandi Jivan*** gave the ideological and recruiting spine for UP–Punjab youth.

Course

- HRA was organised at **Kanpur in 1924** to raise funds and arms for an armed republic.
- Its biggest public action was the **Kakori train treasury seizure (9 August 1925)** — full CCR under 11.14.
- It is **not** yet HSRA. The word **Socialist** is added only in **1928**.

Results

- Kakori hangings broke much of the first HRA cadre; **Chandrashekhar Azad** escaped and rebuilt the underground toward **HSRA**.
- Labelling Kakori as HSRA is the classic trap — Kakori is **HRA 1925**.

> **Logic:** HRA **1924**. Kakori **1925** = HRA. HSRA **1928**.

11.13 Hindustan Socialist Republican Association (HSRA)

Year:September 1928Place:Feroz Shah Kotla, Delhi **Turn:** HRA renamed; **socialist** goal added **Leaders:Chandrashekhar Azad**, **Bhagat Singh**, **Sukhdev**, **Rajguru**, **Bhagwati Charan (चारण) Vohra**

- **Naujawan Bharat Sabha** was founded in **1926** at **Lahore** as the open youth front. **Bhagat Singh**, **Yashpal** and **Chhabil Das** were early members; **Ambika Chakravarti** of Chittagong was **not** among them.

Saunders killing and the Central Assembly Bomb — Cause

- **Lala Lajpat Rai** (लाला लाजपत राय) died on **17 November 1928** after police lathi-charged the Simon Commission (साइमन कमीशन) protest at Lahore, giving HSRA a martyr to avenge.
- By 1929 HSRA wanted a dramatic act inside the seat of government itself, to make the demand for independence impossible to ignore.

Course

- HSRA killed ASP **John Saunders** at Lahore on **17 December 1928** in revenge for Lajpat Rai's death; they had actually aimed at the officer Scott.
- On **8 April 1929**, **Bhagat Singh** and **Batukeshwar Dutt** threw bombs and pamphlets in the **Central Assembly** in Delhi, then shouted slogans and deliberately **courted arrest** instead of fleeing.
- The bombs were meant to **make the deaf hear**, not to kill members — a calculated act of propaganda, not a massacre.

Results

- Bhagat Singh, Dutt and other members stood trial; in the separate **Lahore Conspiracy Case**, Bhagat Singh, Rajguru and Sukhdev were hanged on **23 March 1931** at Lahore.
- The trial and executions made Bhagat Singh a mass hero and hardened youth sympathy for the revolutionary line, even as HSRA itself was broken as an organisation.
- **Azad** kept the underground alive until he died in a gunfight at **Alfred Park, Allahabad, on 27 February 1931**.
- **Jatin Das**, arrested in the Lahore Conspiracy supplementary case, died after a **63-day** hunger strike for jail reforms on **13 September 1929**.
- **Inquilab (इंकलाब) Zindabad** was coined by **Hasrat Mohani**; **Bhagat Singh** made it the revolutionary slogan.
- Bhagat Singh held that **criticism and independent thinking** are indispensable qualities of a revolutionary.

> **Logic:** Assembly bomb **1929** = HSRA. Saunders **1928** = HSRA. Kakori **1925** = HRA.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2021, Q108

> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor (UPPCS 2021 Q108): Naujawan Bharat Sabha** was founded in March 1926 at Lahore by **Bhagat Singh**, Chhabil Das, and Yashpal. **Ambika Chakravarti** was a leader of the Chittagong Armoury Raid in Bengal, not an early member of the Lahore Sabha.

11.14 Kakori Conspiracy (1925) — UP Focus

Date:9 August 1925Place: near **Kakori**, on the Saharanpur–Lucknow line (before Lucknow) **Organisation:HRA** (not HSRA) **Target:** government **treasury bags** on the No. 8 Down train

Cause

- HRA needed money to buy arms for an eventual armed rising, and government treasury bags moving by train were an easy, symbolic target that struck at the state's own money.

Course

- The group pulled the train's chain, overpowered the guard, and seized the cash bags. A passenger, **Ahmad Ali**, was killed in the confusion.
- The British treated it as a full conspiracy case, not petty theft, and arrested HRA members across UP.
- Participants included **Ram Prasad Bismil**, **Ashfaqulla Khan**, **Rajendra Lahiri**, **Chandrashekhar Azad** and **Manmath Nath Gupta (गुप्त)**.

Result

- **Bismil**, born on **11 June 1897** at **Shahjahanpur**, was hanged on **19 December 1927** at **Gorakhpur Jail**.
- The poem *Sarfaroshi ki Tamanna* is by **Bismil Azimabadi** (Patna), not Ram Prasad Bismil — a frequent wrong-pair trap.
- **Ashfaqulla Khan** was hanged the same day at **Faizabad Jail** — he and Bismil are remembered as the Hindu–Muslim revolutionary pair.
- Notes often tag Ashfaqulla as the **first recorded Muslim** hanged for the freedom struggle (age about **27**).
- Days before hanging, **Bismil** refused offered milk and said he would take only his **mother's milk**.
- **Rajendra Lahiri** was hanged on **17 December 1927** at **Gonda**; **Thakur Roshan Singh** was hanged on **19 December 1927** at **Naini (Allahabad)**.
- **Azad escaped** the hangings, rebuilt the underground into HSRA, and died at **Alfred Park, Allahabad, on 27 February 1931**.

> **Logic:** Kakori = **1925 HRA**. Birth **Shahjahanpur** ≠ hanging **Gorakhpur**. Not Surya Sen. Not HSRA by name.

11.15 Chittagong Armoury Raid (1930)

Date:18 April 1930Place: Chittagong (Bengal; now Bangladesh) **Leader:Surya Sen (Master-da)Group name used:** Indian Republican Army (सेना), Chittagong

Cause

- Surya Sen's group wanted a dramatic armed strike, timed with the launch of Gandhi (गांधी)'s Civil Disobedience (सविनय अवज्ञा) Movement, to show that revolutionary and mass politics could act

together against the Raj.
- Seizing government arms would let them equip a wider rising if the town could be held even briefly.

Course

- Revolutionaries seized the **police and Auxiliary Force armouries** on **18 April 1930**, cut communications, and tried to hold the town, though they could not reach the ammunition dump.
- After fighting British forces on **Jalalabad hill**, the surviving raiders scattered underground.
- **Pritilata Waddedar** later led a raid on the Pahartali European Club in **1932** and died in the action; **Kalpana Datta (Joshi)** was captured. **Ganesh Ghosh**, **Ananta Singh** and **Lokenath Bal** are the male lieutenant tags.

Result

- **Surya Sen** was captured in **1933** and hanged in **1934**, ending the Chittagong network as an organised force.
- **Ambika Chakravarti** belongs to this Chittagong circle — the reason he is the odd man out in the 1926 Naujawan Sabha question.
- Chronology: Ghadar (**1913**) → Berlin Committee (**1915**) → Assembly bomb (**1929**) → Chittagong (**1930**).

> **Logic:** Chittagong = **18 April 1930 + Surya Sen**. Not Kakori. Not Bhagat Singh's Assembly action.

11.16 Other Revolutionary Events

Chapekar brothers (1897) — Cause → Course → Result

Causes

- Plague measures under commissioner **W.C. Rand** in Poona were harsh and humiliating; local anger mixed with early militant nationalism.
- The Chapekar brothers (**Damodar** (दामोदर), **Balkrishna**, **Vasudev**) ran a **Vyayam Mandal** with political intent (**1896–97**).

Course

- In **June 1897** they killed plague commissioner **Rand** and Lt. **Ayerst**. Damodar was hanged; the Dravid brothers informed the police.
- Britishers also tried to implicate **Tilak** (तिलक); in **July 1897** he was convicted of sedition under **IPC 124-A** for about **18 months**.

Results

- That ordeal made Tilak an all-India name and people styled him **Lokmanya**.
- The Chapekar strike is early militant action — not the same organisation as Abhinav Bharat, which comes later under Savarkar.

Barrah Dacoity (1908)

- Led by **Pulin Behari Das** in **East Bengal** (Dhaka Anushilan). It is keyed as an early major revolutionary dacoity for funds.

Women revolutionaries (Bengal, early 1930s)

- In **December 1931**, school students **Shanti Ghosh** (शांति घोष) and **Suniti Chaudhary** shot a district magistrate.
- In **1932**, **Bina Das** fired at the Bengal Governor at a Calcutta University convocation.

Gopinath Saha and Charles Tegart (1924)

- **Gopinath Saha** tried to kill Calcutta Police Commissioner **Charles Tegart** but killed another Englishman by mistake and was hanged (**1924**).

Passive Resistance (Aurobindo)

- **Aurobindo Ghosh** formulated **Passive Resistance** in the paper ***Bande Mataram*** — assertive political resistance short of Congress Moderate petition politics.

Forward Bloc (फॉरवर्ड ब्लॉक) (1939)

- After resigning Congress presidentship, **Subhas Chandra Bose** (सुभाष चंद्र बोस) founded the **Forward Bloc** on **3 May 1939** (later politics; keep distinct from HSRA).

RSS (1925) — do not confuse with HRA

- **Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh** was founded by **Keshav Baliram Hedgewar** on **27 September 1925** at **Nagpur**.
- It is a **Hindu social–organisational** body, **not** the revolutionary HRA that staged Kakori the same year.

Provisional Government of India (Kabul, 1915)

- During World War I, **Raja Mahendra Pratap** (President) and **Maulavi Barkatullah** (Prime Minister) set up a provisional government of free India at **Kabul**.

Udham Singh (1940)

- In London (**March 1940**), **Udham Singh** killed **Michael O'Dwyer**, former Punjab lieutenant-governor linked in public memory to Jallianwala Bagh (जलियांवाला बाग). He was hanged for the act.

India Independence League (Japan)

- **Rash Behari Bose** organised Indians in Japan and founded the **Indian Independence League** (Tokyo/Bangkok wartime conferences, **1942**), later inviting Subhas Chandra Bose.

Kanpur Conspiracy Case (1924)

- Early **communist** case, not HRA. Accused included **Muzaffar Ahmed, S.A. Dange, Shaukat Usmani, Nalini Gupta**.
- **M.A. Ansari** was **not** among the early AITUC (एटक) presidents.

Mainpuri Conspiracy (1918)

- This was in UP.
- **Gendalal Dixit** and others took part.
- It was a stepping stone toward later HRA work in the province.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2021, Q86

> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor (UPPCS 2021 Q86):** In the **Kanpur Bolshevik Conspiracy Case (1924)**, the British government tried communist leaders S.A. Dange, Muzaffar Ahmad, Shaukat Usmani, and Nalini Gupta. **Dr. M.A. Ansari** was a nationalist Congress leader, not an accused in this case.

UP Focus

Fact	Detail
Kakori	9 Aug 1925, Lucknow belt, **HRA**
Bismil	Born **Shahjahanpur**; hanged **Gorakhpur**
Ashfaqulla	Hanged **Faizabad**
Lahiri	Hanged **Gonda**
Roshan Singh	Hanged **Naini**
Azad	Died **Alfred Park, Allahabad, 27 Feb 1931**

11.17 Master Fact-Locks — Swadeshi & Revolutionary Movements High-Yield Repository

Organisation / Incident / Leader	Founders / Key Person	Year / Place	Key Diagnostic Fact & Exam Anchor
Partition of Bengal	Lord Curzon (Lt. Gov. Andrew Fraser)	20 July 1905 (announced) / 16 Oct 1905 (effect)	Partitioned into East Bengal & Assam (HQ Dacca) and West Bengal (Bihar & Odisha); 16 Oct observed as Mourning Day & *Rakhi Diwas* (on Tagore's suggestion); annulled at Delhi Durbar on 12 Dec 1911 by King George V.

Organisation / Incident / Leader	Founders / Key Person	Year / Place	Key Diagnostic Fact & Exam Anchor
Swadeshi Movement & Boycott	Krishna Kumar Mitra (*Sanjivani* editor)	7 Aug 1905 (Calcutta Town Hall)	Boycott resolution passed on 7 Aug 1905 (celebrated as National Handloom Day). Led by Tilak in Bombay/Poona, Lala Lajpat Rai & Ajit Singh in Punjab/UP, Syed Haider Raja in Delhi, and Chidambaram Pillai in Madras (*Swadeshi Steam Navigation Co.*). Ashwini Kumar Dutt formed *Swadesh Bandhav Samiti* (Barisal). Abanindranath Tagore painted *Bharat Mata* (1905) and founded Indian Society of Oriental Art (1907). Title song: *Vande Mataram*. British journalist H.W. Nevinson documented it in *The New Spirit in India*.
Mitra Mela & Abhinav Bharat	V.D. Savarkar & Ganesh Savarkar	1899 (Nasik) / 1904	Reorganized as secret revolutionary society Abhinav Bharat; London branch opened at India House 1906; Savarkar authored *The Indian War of Independence 1857* and Mazzini biography; escaped through porthole at Marseilles (1910).
Vyayam Mandal & Chapekar Brothers	Damodar, Balkrishna & Vasudev Chapekar	1896–97 (Poona)	Assassinated Plague Commissioner W.C. Rand and Lt. Ayerst on 22 June 1897; Damodar was hanged; informed by Dravid brothers; led to Tilak's 18-month sedition trial.
Anushilan Samiti	Promotha Nath Mitra, Jatindranath Mukherjee (Bagha Jatin), Barindra Ghosh	1902 (Calcutta & Midnapore) / 1906 (Dacca)	Midnapore by Gyanendranath Basu; Calcutta by P. Mitra & Satish Chandra Basu; Dacca Anushilan Samiti founded Oct 1906 by Pulin Bihari Das (led Barrah Dacoity 1908). Organised Muzaffarpur bombing and Alipore Conspiracy.
Muzaffarpur Bomb Case	Khudiram Bose & Prafulla Chaki	30 April 1908 (Muzaffarpur)	Target was Chief Presidency Magistrate Kingsford; carriage carrying Mrs. & Miss Kennedy hit; Prafulla shot himself; Khudiram Bose hanged on 11 Aug 1908 (youngest martyr, age 18 yrs, 8 mos).
Alipore Conspiracy Case	Aurobindo Ghosh, Barindra Ghosh, Ullaskar Dutt	1908 (Maniktala raid)	39 arrested with illegal arms/bombs; Chittaranjan Das brilliantly defended Aurobindo Ghosh (acquitted); Kanailal Dutt & Satyendranath Bose shot approver Naren Goswami in jail and were hanged.
Jackson Murder / Nasik Conspiracy	Anant Laxman Kanhere (Karve group)	21 Dec 1909 (Nasik)	Shot Collector A.M.T. Jackson at theater; Kanhere, Krishnaji Karve, and Vinayak Deshpande were hanged; Savarkar implicated and given life imprisonment at Cellular Jail.
Delhi Conspiracy Case	Rash Behari Bose & Master Amir Chand	23 Dec 1912 (Delhi)	Threw bomb on Viceroy Lord Hardinge at Chandni Chowk; Basanta Kumar Biswas, Master Amir Chand, Avadh Behari, and Bal Mukund hanged; Rash Behari escaped to Japan.

Organisation / Incident / Leader	Founders / Key Person	Year / Place	Key Diagnostic Fact & Exam Anchor
Hindustan Republican Association (HRA)	Sachindra Nath Sanyal (Pres.), Ram Prasad Bismil, Jogesh Chatterjee, Chandrashekhar Azad	Oct 1924 (Kanpur)	Manifesto *The Revolutionary*; executed Kakori Train Action on 9 Aug 1925 (8-Down train looted near Lucknow). Ram Prasad Bismil (hanged in Gorakhpur), Ashfaqullah Khan (hanged in Faizabad), Roshan Singh (hanged in Naini/Allahabad), Rajendra Lahiri (hanged in Gonda); Chandrashekhar Azad escaped. Bismil quote: *"Now I will take my mother's milk only"*; poem *"Sarfaroshi ki Tamanna"* written by Bismil Azimabadi (1921). Govind Ballabh Pant headed defense committee.
Hindustan Socialist Republican Association (HSRA)	Chandrashekhar Azad, Bhagat Singh, Sukhdev, Shiv Verma	Sept 1928 (Feroz Shah Kotla, Delhi)	Adopted socialist objective; Saunders assassination (17 Dec 1928, Lahore) in revenge for Lala Lajpat Rai; Central Legislative Assembly Bomb (8 April 1929) by Bhagat Singh & Batukeshwar Dutt ("to make the deaf hear"); slogan *"Inquilab Zindabad"* (coined by Hasrat Mohani, popularized by Bhagat Singh). Azad martyred at Alfred Park Allahabad (27 Feb 1931). Bhagat Singh, Rajguru, Sukhdev executed on 23 March 1931 (Lahore Conspiracy); memorial at Hussainiwala/Ferozepur on Sutlej bank.
Jatin Das Hunger Strike	Jatindra Nath Das	13 Sept 1929 (Lahore Jail)	63-day hunger strike demanding political prisoner status for revolutionaries in jail; died a martyr.
Naujawan Bharat Sabha	Bhagat Singh, Chhabil Das, Yashpal	March 1926 (Lahore)	Leftist youth and worker association; propagated secularism and revolution.
Chittagong Armoury Raid	Surya Sen ("Master Da") & Indian Republican Army (IRA)	18 April 1930 (Chittagong)	Raided police & auxiliary armouries; proclaimed provisional revolutionary government; Jalalabad Hill battle (22 April 1930); associates: Ganesh Ghosh, Lokenath Bal, Ambika Chakraborty, Kalpana Dutt (sentenced to life), Pritilata Waddedar (martyred at Pahartali European Club 1932); Surya Sen arrested Feb 1933 and hanged 12 Jan 1934.
Women Revolutionaries of Bengal	Shanti Ghosh, Suniti Chowdhury, Bina Das	1931–1932	Schoolgirls Shanti & Suniti shot dead DM Stevens of Comilla (Dec 1931); Bina Das fired point-blank at Governor Stanley Jackson during Calcutta University convocation (Feb 1932).
India House & Indian Home Rule Society	Shyamji Krishna Varma	Feb 1905 (London)	Published *The Indian Sociologist*; center for Savarkar, Dhingra, Lala Har Dayal. Madan Lal Dhingra shot Curzon Wyllie on 1 July 1909 (hanged at Pentonville).

Organisation / Incident / Leader	Founders / Key Person	Year / Place	Key Diagnostic Fact & Exam Anchor
Ghadar Party	Sohan Singh Bhakna (Pres.) & Lala Har Dayal (Gen. Sec.)	21 April 1913 (San Francisco)	Began as Pacific Coast Hindustan Association; HQ *Yugantar Ashram* (San Francisco); organ *Ghadar* in Urdu, Gurumukhi, Hindi, Gujarati, Marathi; key leaders: Kartar Singh Sarabha, Bhai Parmanand, Barkatullah, Rash Behari Bose. First World War outbreak seen as opportunity to wage armed struggle in India.
Provisional Government of Free India, Kabul	Raja Mahendra Pratap (Pres.) & Maulavi Barkatullah (PM)	1915 (Kabul, Afghanistan)	First provisional government in exile during WWI; recognized by Germany and Russia.
Madam Bhikaji Cama	Madam Bhikaji Rustom Cama	22 Aug 1907 (Stuttgart, Germany)	"Mother of Indian Revolution"; Parsi patriot; personal secretary to Dadabhai Naoroji; first to hoist Indian National Flag on foreign soil at International Socialist Congress; flag designed by Cama, Savarkar & Shyamji Varma.
Komagata Maru Incident	Baba Gurdit Singh	1914 (Vancouver & Budge Budge)	Japanese steamship chartered with 376 passengers; Canadian authorities refused entry under Continuous Journey regulation; returned to Budge Budge (Calcutta) on 27 Sept 1914; British police firing killed 20 passengers; Shore Committee formed by Hussain Rahim, Balwant Singh, Sohan Lal Pathak.
Assassination of Michael O'Dwyer	Sardar Udham Singh	13 March 1940 (London)	Shot Michael O'Dwyer (Lt. Governor of Punjab during Jallianwala Bagh) at Caxton Hall London; Udham Singh executed on 31 July 1940.
Indian Independence League	Rash Behari Bose	March & June 1942 (Tokyo & Bangkok)	Formed to mobilize overseas Indians in East Asia for freedom struggle; handed over leadership to Subhash Chandra Bose in 1943.